FREE CHECKLIST · November 2026

GEO and AI Visibility Checklist

40 checks to improve your chances of being cited in Google AI Overviews, AI Mode and chat assistants: technical basics, entity clarity, content, bots and measurement.

6 sections · 40 checks

How to use this checklist

Complete the 'Technical basics' section first: to appear in Google's AI features, standard indexing and snippet eligibility are enough, with no extra file or markup required. 'High' items are prerequisites for visibility; 'medium' items improve your chances of being cited, and 'low' items are fine-tuning and monitoring.

Priority: **High** **Medium** **Low**

01 Technical basics: indexing and snippet eligibility

- [ ] **Verify that the key pages you want to surface are in Google's index; this is the first requirement for being a supporting link in AI Overviews and AI Mode.** — High
  How: Use Search Console URL Inspection to confirm 'URL is on Google' for each key URL; review non-indexed reasons in the Pages report.
- [ ] **Check that key pages do not use nosnippet, max-snippet:0 or broad data-nosnippet; these limit snippet display and use in AI features.** — High
  How: Export meta robots and X-Robots-Tag values from your crawler and search the source for elements with data-nosnippet.
- [ ] **Verify that robots.txt does not block Googlebot from key pages or the CSS/JS resources they need.** — High
  How: Open the Search Console robots.txt report and use 'Test live URL' in URL Inspection to check page resources load.
- [ ] **Confirm that the main content exists as text in the server or rendered HTML and is not only in images or loaded after interaction.** — High
  How: In URL Inspection, open 'View tested page' > HTML and search for a sentence from the main paragraphs.
- [ ] **Verify that structured data matches the visible text, and make clear to the team that AI features require no special schema type.** — Medium
  How: Compare values in the Rich Results Test or Schema Markup Validator output with the text on the page.
- [ ] **Do not plan llms.txt as a requirement for Google visibility; Google Search does not use it, so if you add it for other tools keep it low priority.** — Low
  How: If your roadmap marks llms.txt as 'required for Google', correct it and cite Google's AI features documentation.

- [ ] **Add your site to Bing Webmaster Tools and submit your sitemap; the Bing index feeds Microsoft AI experiences such as Copilot.** — Medium
  How: In Bing Webmaster Tools, confirm the sitemap status is successful and key pages are indexed via URL Inspection.

02 Entity clarity

- [ ] **Add Organization structured data with name, url, logo and sameAs to the homepage or About page.** — High
  How: Test the homepage in the Schema Markup Validator and confirm the Organization item is detected without errors.
- [ ] **Add Person structured data (name, jobTitle, sameAs) to author pages for personal brands or expert authors.** — Medium
  How: Test an author page in the Schema Markup Validator and check that the author field in articles links to that page's URL.
- [ ] **List only verified profiles you own in sameAs (LinkedIn, Wikidata, YouTube, official social accounts).** — Medium
  How: Open every URL in sameAs and check the profile is active and links back to your site.
- [ ] **Write your brand name, short description, address and contact details identically on your site, Google Business Profile and social profiles.** — High
  How: Copy brand details from every profile into a sheet, flag spelling differences and fix them.
- [ ] **Publish an About page that explains in one paragraph what your brand does, who it serves and where it operates.** — High
  How: Read the first paragraph of the About page; rewrite it if it does not answer these three questions, and link it from the footer.
- [ ] **Use one consistent name for each service and product across the site; do not use different names for the same offering.** — Medium
  How: Use site search or your crawler's custom search to find synonymous service names and consolidate them into one term.
- [ ] **If your brand has a Wikidata entry, check it is up to date; if not, check whether you meet the notability rules for one.** — Low
  How: Search your brand on Wikidata and verify the official website, founding date and social profile fields are correct.

03 Citable content structure

- [ ] **On every key page, answer the main question clearly in 40-60 words in the first paragraph, then expand on the details.** — High
  How: Read the first paragraph on its own and check whether it answers the headline question without needing context.
- [ ] **Write H2 and H3 headings that mirror the questions users ask, and make each section understandable on its own.** — Medium
  How: Extract the heading outline with a browser extension and compare it with question-style queries in Search Console.
- [ ] **Present comparisons, steps and specifications as HTML tables or lists rather than plain paragraphs.** — Medium
  How: Check in the source that comparison content is marked up with <table>, <ol> or <ul> elements.

- [ ] **Link the figures and claims you cite to their primary source and state the date of the data.** Medium
  How: List every statistic on the page and update or remove those without a source and date.
- [ ] **Add original information that is not available elsewhere, such as your own data, case studies or first-hand experience.** High
  How: Compare the page with the top 5 competing results and confirm it has at least one data point or example only you offer.
- [ ] **Add a visible author name, a link to the author page, and published and updated dates to articles.** Medium
  How: Check the article template shows these four elements and that they match datePublished/dateModified in the Article markup.
- [ ] **Review and update key pages with time-sensitive information at least every six months.** Low
  How: Add a 'last reviewed' column to your content inventory and schedule rows older than six months.

04 Brand mentions and off-site signals

- [ ] **List where your brand is and is not mentioned in trusted industry publications, lists and comparison content.** Medium
  How: Mark the lists in top results for target queries and the sources cited in AI answers in a sheet.
- [ ] **Set up monitoring for unlinked brand mentions and request corrections for inaccurate information.** Low
  How: Add your brand name and common misspellings to Google Alerts and review incoming mentions monthly.
- [ ] **Create content with original research, data or expert commentary that journalists can quote, and pitch it to relevant publications.** Medium
  How: Log the mentions and links earned in the 4-8 weeks after publication in a sheet.
- [ ] **Keep your brand profiles on Google Business Profile, industry directories and review platforms current and complete.** Medium
  How: Check that category, description, website and contact fields are filled and consistent with your site on every profile.
- [ ] **When answering questions about your brand on forums and community platforms, clearly state who you are.** Low
  How: Search your brand on platforms such as Reddit and list threads that are unanswered or contain wrong information.

05 AI bots and robots.txt decisions

- [ ] **Make decisions knowing that blocking Googlebot also removes your visibility in Google Search, including AI Overviews and AI Mode.** High
  How: Check in the Search Console robots.txt report that there is no Disallow rule for Googlebot.
- [ ] **Decide on Google-Extended knowing it does not affect inclusion or ranking in Google Search but controls use for Gemini training and grounding.** Medium
  How: Write down your decision and check that the User-agent: Google-Extended line in robots.txt matches it.

- [ ] **Evaluate training bots (e.g. GPTBot, ClaudeBot) separately from search and user-request bots (e.g. OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, PerplexityBot).** High
  How: Open each provider's official bot documentation and map which user agent serves which purpose in a sheet.
- [ ] **If you want to be cited in assistant answers, verify that you do not block their search bots in robots.txt.** High
  How: Open robots.txt and check the relevant user-agent lines and the Disallow rules under User-agent: *.
- [ ] **Check that your CDN or web application firewall (WAF) does not block AI bots you allow, independently of robots.txt.** Medium
  How: Review bot management rules in your CDN dashboard and search server logs for 403 responses to those user agents.
- [ ] **Monitor monthly in server logs which pages AI bots crawl and how often.** Low
  How: Filter by user agent in your log analyser and verify IPs against the ranges providers publish.

06 Measurement and manual testing

- [ ] **Review which of your pages earn impressions in Search Console's generative AI (AI Overviews / AI Mode) performance reports.** High
  How: Open the generative AI performance report in Search Console and export the page and country breakdown monthly.
- [ ] **Track sessions and conversions from the AI Assistant channel in GA4 separately; this channel does not include Google AI Overviews or AI Mode traffic.** High
  How: In GA4, filter the 'AI Assistant' row by default channel group in the Traffic acquisition report.
- [ ] **Build a fixed set of 20-30 questions about your brand and services.** Medium
  How: Group questions by brand, category and comparison intent; pick them from Search Console queries and customer questions.
- [ ] **Run the question set manually in Google AI Mode, ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity once a month and record whether your brand appears.** Medium
  How: Test in a private window while logged out; record date, platform, appearance and cited URL in a sheet.
- [ ] **If AI answers state wrong information about your brand, find the source and clarify the relevant page on your site.** Medium
  How: Open the links cited in the answer; fix the source if it is your site, or request a correction if it is a third party.
- [ ] **Note in your reports that traffic from AI features is included in the overall Web search type data in Search Console.** Low
  How: Add a note to your reporting template explaining the difference between the Performance (Web) report and the generative AI report.
- [ ] **Compare landing pages and conversion rate for visitors from AI assistants with organic search.** Low
  How: In GA4, add default channel group as a secondary dimension to the Landing page report and compare the two channels.
- [ ] **Review visibility results quarterly and create a content update plan for key pages that are cited least.** Medium
  How: Combine the manual test sheet with the generative AI report and rank pages that do not appear by priority.

Detailed guides

GEO implementation guide
Google AI Overview optimisation
Entity SEO
Brand mentions
AI traffic in GA4
llms.txt guide
robots.txt tester

Need a second pair of eyes on your site? Book a free intro call:
fatihemincakiroglu.com/en/book-a-call

This checklist reflects publicly documented Google guidance as of November 2026. Search features change; check the official documentation before major decisions.